

and then explain how this PC software can be used to sync digital audio and video content with your device.

You should connect your Windows Live ID to a Zune account for the best Windows Phone experience, so hopefully you've already done that. The next step is to download and install the latest version of the Zune PC software. You can find this software at zune.net. It doesn't make sense to provide a complete overview of the Zune PC software here, but I want to at least hit on the basics, so you can have some understanding of how the software is organized and how it works. The Zune PC software is divided into different views, which are accessed via the main menu of choices along the top left of the application. These include:

- ▶ **QuickPlay:** If you're not hugely interested in micromanaging your entire media collection, QuickPlay provides an optional interface for quickly interacting with key parts of that collection, including your favourite items (which can be pinned to this interface, similar to the way Windows Phone live tiles are pinned to the Start screen), new media items, recently accessed media items (called History), and a selection of custom playlists (like electronic, personal radio stations) called Smart DJ. QuickPlay, is the default screen displayed when you launch the Zune PC software.
- ▶ **Collection:** From here, you can gain access to your entire media collection, including music, videos, pictures, podcasts, channels (themed playlists that are constantly updated and, thus, even more like radio stations, but require a Zune Pass subscription), and mobile (Windows Phone and Zune HD) apps. Each media type provides different view filtering possibilities. For example, within the Music section, you can switch between artists, genres, albums, songs, and playlists. Video provides All, TV, Movies, Other, and Personal views. These views are all optimised for the content you're displaying. In Music - Artists, for example, you'll get a three-column view with an artist list, album thumbnails, and a song list, and as you select items, the views all change. But in Music - Albums, the view changes to display large album art thumbnails and a songs list column instead. Some views, such as Music - Playlists, provide only textual columns of information.

The Zune PC software integrates with the libraries feature in Windows 7 to determine which folders it "monitors." So it works with the built-in Music,